that there was no force in the matter; "My dear Burgess. I received last night your lines of the *3rd* instant and this morning I saw your niece and questioned her as to her future happiness. She agrees to take Ferramurz Khan as her lawful husband and moreover she says it is a match of her own making. I saw her all alone — so that it may not be said that her mother was with her. As I see no objection to Ferramurz Khan and as Dick" (his elder brother the consul) "is of the same opinion, and also as there is no chance of his burning his wife's uncle (unless he wants his father burnt in return), I, after questioning Mary gave her your letter for Nargis (the mother). The poor girl looked happy and I am sure she will make Ferramurz the same. I had not seen her since last July" (this was written last May) "and I was quite astonished to find her grown a big woman and what's more something exquisitely pretty." They were married about a month after this and I hear from, and of them, occasionally and they appear to be remarkably happy and well off. Mary was only just fourteen years old when she was married, (again do not be surprised, recollect that Shakespeare's Julia was just that age) and her husband must be about thirty or perhaps more. They now live at Ouroumia and not at Tabreez. I have mentioned this matter to you because I think it would amuse you, but I have never mentioned any thing about this family to my father; I may be wrong, but it appeared to me that it would show a want of delicacy, to write about his sons illegitimate family, to a father perhaps even a want of respect. Now that Charles' daughter is married I have less of that feeling, and I shall perhaps send this letter open to him. As to Charles, I suspect he neither knows, or cares any thing about the woman or his children and perhaps has forgot even their very existence, at least I know he has never written to enquire about them since he felt Persia; but I confess that her being so well married gives me great pleasure, for I should have been very willing to have had her married to any respectable tailor or carpenter when she had grown a little older; when I was at Tabreez as she lived near I often used to make her come and make tea for me, and I think she was fond of me, for rather more than two years ago when I was obliged to march to Tehran with the king she nearly cried her eyes out; I thought of bringing her and her mother here so as to have them near and be able to look after them better, but being married and settled at Ouroumia she is much better off.

[EDWARD BURGESS TO GEORGE BURGESS] *Tehran, April 22, 1851*

I am by no means certain that I have answered your kind letter of the 11*th* Nov*r* altho if I am not mistaken, I have written to you since its arrival because I think I recollect mentioning that the gov*t* had started a state gazette and made

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